



PROGRESS REPORT

Rural digital data capture: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-26

Edition of 2026-08-26 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

18 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

BURUNDI · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CONGO · EGYPT · ESWATINI · GUINEA · LESOTHO · MALAWI · MALI · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SIERRA LEONE · TOGO · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Burundi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Villages Numeriques programme	Baseline not held	Under way; no completion date or coverage achieved on file	BASELINE NOT HELD

Central African Republic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
First free public Wi-Fi point	Did not exist	One site, presented as the country's first free public internet access point, with technical support from Russian cooperation	ADVANCED
Universal service fund school and community connectivity	The fund created by a 2018 law with a 2019 implementing decree and never operational; its supervising committee's activities launched July 2025	Effective implementation stated for 2026, financed by a 2% levy on operators' previous-year turnover, with scope covering broadband in schools, health centres, town halls, libraries and post offices	ADVANCED

Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural connectivity site commissioning	No site count on file	20 sites fully operational against a 76-site target for end-2025, with the remainder described as in advanced stages and no updated count published since	ADVANCED

Egypt

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Decent Life rural fibre programme	856 of 1,450 phase-one villages connected at end-2024, up from 267 at end-2023	More than 1,250 of 1,450 phase-one villages across 52 markazes in 20 governorates, about 5 million fibre lines, 75% of village service complexes connected	ADVANCED

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
USSD access to public services	Did not exist	Planned for the 2027 rollout	ADVANCED
Agricultural extension officer digital devices	Not held	40 tablets and 4 laptops, valued at E313,504, handed to agricultural extension officers on 10 August 2026 under an IFAD and Green Climate Fund-backed project, for real-time crop, livestock and weather reporting by officers working with smallholder farmers across all four regions	BASELINE NOT HELD

Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Agriculteurs Connectes de Guinee	BASELINE NOT HELD	A first cohort running, pairing a private agritech's field sensors, weather alerts and agronomic advice with the state rural bank's network of over 1,000 service points	Baseline not held

Lesotho

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
T-Connect Impact school and clinic connectivity	Did not exist	Operating, following the first community hotspots handed over at Matsieng, Thaba Bosiu and Mokhotlong in September 2025	ADVANCED

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
University AI fertigation facility, Thyolo	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	The Malawi University of Science and Technology commissioned an AI-powered fertigation system automating irrigation and fertiliser application from real-time crop-growth data at its Thyolo campus, with an AI-assisted smart tree nursery, under a continental agricultural-universities programme	ADVANCED
National Agricultural Data Infrastructure	A multi-stakeholder dialogue on national data infrastructure for climate decision-making held in Malawi in September 2023, drawing conclusions on digitising paper records, standardising collection and embedding interoperability; nothing built	Farmers across 14 districts still use non-interoperable platforms - the meteorological department's, an agricultural NGO's, the government farm input subsidy programme's and a commodity exchange's - logging into each separately; the harmonising framework remains a proposal and a farmer-ID layer on the national register remains an argument, not a system	NO CHANGE

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Rural and white-zone coverage	No white-zone map published	An updated universal-access strategy with a white-zone map recommended, against a 2030 universal connectivity target	ADVANCED

Morocco

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mobile identity enrolment units	80 units, more than 130,000 citizens served (2024)	Same; no later figure held	NO CHANGE
Registry extension to rural and remote areas	Extension via digital and remote applications, targets stated (2024-12)	Same; the end-2024 target date has passed with no delivery or coverage figure held	NO CHANGE

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Satellite connectivity partnership with Angola	A proof of concept under way; discussions began June 2025	A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot	ADVANCED

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Villages Intelligents rural inclusion programme	Did not exist	One centre on record, with women's and girls' digital skills training	ADVANCED

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Cisco AI for smallholder farmers	Did not exist	Exploratory; no programme, funding, timeline or counterparty ministry named	ADVANCED
Rural connectivity programmes	Baseline not held	About 3,700 towers to start deploying around October 2026 against 23% of rural communities connected (2025-10)	ADVANCED

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
School internet connectivity	3,082 schools connected in 2023/24, about 62% by late 2024	4,184 of 4,996 connected with 812 outstanding, rural at about 27% against urban at about 75%	ADVANCED

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Agricultural interactive voice response platform	Not held	An upgraded interactive voice response platform reported 98% complete, to give farmers direct access to agriculture ministry officials under the national food-security agenda	BASELINE NOT HELD

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Spectrum royalties for satellite and machine-to-machine services	The 2023 rate schedule in force, with no satellite or machine-to-machine rates	Amendment adopted to price spectrum use for satellite services and satellite machine-to-machine traffic, so specialised operators can establish and rural connectivity extend; the text and its rates were unpublished at 2026-07-31	ADVANCED

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Satellite terminals in rural public facilities	Kits deployed in underserved public facilities since 2024, year only	A rural health clinic and two primary schools connected for access to government services through the national portal; no national count of connected facilities published	ADVANCED

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural network population coverage	BASELINE NOT HELD	5G reaches 0.0% of the rural population against 18.9% nationally; 3G reaches 73.7%; 4,681 of 13,104 base stations are rural	<i>Baseline not held</i>
School connectivity and solar programme	Not held	11,500 satellite terminals distributed to schools - 8,000 to those with no wireless network and a further 3,500 to those already connected - with more than 1,300 institutions still to reach and a stated target of internet connectivity, solar power and national-grid access at every school by December 2026; cabinet has separately committed 3% of GDP to research and innovation under the education framework	BASELINE NOT HELD
Universal services fund subscription support	BASELINE NOT HELD	One year of subscription support for digital centres and schools, with extension to rural health centres said to be under consideration; no fund size or disbursement figure held	<i>Baseline not held</i>

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.